

1NT BALANCED RAISE

Partner opens 1NT (15-17). You are balanced with no four-card or five-card major, so there is no Stayman bid and no transfer to make -- you raise notrump straight to the level your points call for. Pass with 0-7, invite game with 2NT on 8-9, and bid game with 3NT on 10-15. With slam values keep bidding notrump: 4NT is a quantitative slam invitation on about 16-17, and with 18-19 bid 6NT to play. Opener passes a minimum over your 2NT or 4NT and accepts with a maximum.

A pure point-count decision: add your points to partner's 15-17 and pick the level.